



Level 3 Diploma in Software Development

Student handbook



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Welcome

Congratulations on taking your first step to becoming a Software Developer! We're excited to bring you on this journey!

During the course you will develop the skills to launch your career in software development. The commitment is great on both sides. As a learner, you must apply yourself with enthusiasm, consistency and a positive approach to learning new skills.

It's important to remain focused, make sacrifices and keep your eye on the prize - a Level 3 Diploma in Software Development.

It's not going to be easy and it will certainly challenge you but we're here to support you and guide you on this journey.

We look forward to working with you - now let's get coding!

Welcome Emails

We have sent you some emails with vital information about the course. Please make sure you locate them and keep them filed together for your records.



Invitation to Slack

You should have received an invitation to slack via email. There is a link in this email that you can click on to set up your slack profile. Slack is your online student community where you can network, avail of peer to peer support as well as community tutoring. We have a zero tolerance policy to bullying or abuse on slack so if you have any concerns please contact us on - studentcare@codeinstitute.net



LMS Access

You will access your course material on the LMS Learning Management System. We have sent you an email with a link to log into the LMS. Your Email address is your username and your password is the same as you used for the 5 day coding challenge. If you need to reset your password there is an option to do that. All of your course content can be found on the LMS.



LMS Access

01

What is the LMS

Learning Management System

02

What is this for?

Accessing the learning material.

03

How do I log in?

<https://learn.codeinstitute.net>

04

Username:

The email address you signed up to the course with.

05

Password:

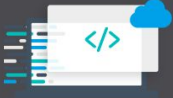
The password you used for the 5 day coding challenge.



Getting set up - LMS Access

Here you will access your 2 content sections:

Your Software Development Course



Level 3 Diploma in Software Development

[View Programme](#)

Your Careers Corner



Careers Corner

Your careers journey

[View Programme](#)

Getting set up - Slack

● Why should I use Slack?

Discover your virtual campus in our Slack workspace! Here, you can connect with fellow students and find peer-to-peer support. Students who are active in our Slack community consistently achieve better outcomes on their course. Join us to enhance your learning experience and succeed together!

● 1 Log in

You will have received an email from feedback@slack.com.

● 2 Add your name

With multiple courses taking place in our workspace, we kindly ask you to follow our naming convention by adding “_L3” to your Slack name. This helps us provide you with the best support possible.

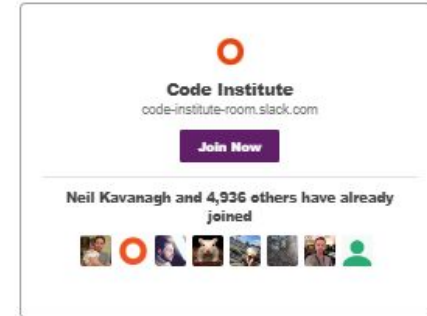
● 3 Introduce yourself

Introduce yourself to your classmates in your cohort channel. This is a great way to start networking and meet your fellow students!



Join your team on Slack

Neil Kavanagh (neil.kavanagh@codeinstitute.net) has invited you to use Slack with them, in a workspace called Code Institute.



What is Slack?

Slack is a messaging app for teams, a place you can collaborate on projects and organize conversations — so you can work together, no matter where you are. [Learn more about Slack](#)

If you have any questions about Slack or the Code Institute community, please reach out to our Community Team.
Slack name: @community
Email: community@codeinstitute.net

Programme Modules



Programming Implementation (PI):

Unit Aim	Learners will become familiar with the underpinning concepts of programming and how it is implemented.
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Learning Outcomes	Assessment Criteria
The learner will:	The learner can:
1. Explain the principles and concepts of programming languages.	1.1 Explain the principles and concepts of programming languages.
2. Understand how programming is implemented.	2.1 Interpret variables within programming languages. 2.2 Interpret common programming control structures that are used when developing code. 2.3 Describe the use of common data structures. 2.4 Describe how algorithms are used in programming. 2.5 Describe how to test and debug programs.
3. Understand the importance of good programming practices.	3.1 Identify the elements of common coding standards. 3.2 Explain the role and importance of good coding practices.
4. Understand functional and non-functional requirements in programming	4.1 Identify the types of functional and non-functional requirements. 4.2 Describe the tests used for functional and non-functional requirements.

Object Oriented Programming (OOP):

Unit Aim	Learners will become familiar with the underpinning concepts of object oriented programming to develop skills in an object oriented language. They will look at the features, tools and techniques of object oriented programming and use a structured approach to the design and development of a program, ensuring it is documented and tested against user requirements.
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Learning Outcomes	Assessment Criteria
The learner will:	The learner can:
1. Understand the features of object oriented programming.	1.1 Explain the key features of object oriented programming. 1.2 Explain the importance of encapsulation, inheritance and polymorphism in object oriented programming.
2. Be able to use tools and techniques of an object oriented programming language.	2.1 Demonstrate use of object oriented tools and techniques.
3. Be able to design and develop an object oriented program to meet requirements.	3.1 Design an object oriented program. 3.2 Develop an object oriented program.
4. Be able to test and document an object oriented program.	4.1 Test an object oriented program. 4.2 Document appropriate action to correct errors. 4.3 Create technical documentation for the support and maintenance of the program.

Software Testing (ST):

Unit Aim	Learners will develop an understanding of testing strategies and techniques and the stages from planning to acceptance testing. They will also understand how automation can be applied to software testing and will implement test plans, identify appropriate test data and record results.
Learning Outcomes	Assessment Criteria
The learner will:	The learner can:
1. Understand software testing.	1.1 Explain the purpose and methods of software testing. 1.2 Describe the different stages and types of software testing. 1.3 Explain how automation is used in software testing. 1.4 Describe functional and structural testing.
2. Be able to develop and implement a test plan.	2.1 Design appropriate test data. 2.2 Develop a test plan in line with requirements. 2.3 Implement a test plan and record results. 2.4 Produce a test report.

Programming with JavaScript (JS):

Unit Aim	Learners will develop an understanding of JavaScript as a text-based programming language to create interactive elements on web pages.
Learning Outcomes	Assessment Criteria
The learner will:	The learner can:
1. Understand the use of JavaScript in web development.	1.1 Explain how JavaScript is used as a web programming language.
2. Be able to use JavaScript in web pages.	2.1 Use JavaScript to prompt and validate inputs in web pages. 2.2 Use document. Write to display messages in web pages. 2.3 Alter, show, hide and move objects in web pages. 2.4 Use JavaScript to include special effects in web pages. 2.5 Use functions and variables to customise web pages. 2.6 Use functions and variables for functional web pages. 2.7 Use event handlers to trigger JavaScript code.

Project Management (PM):

Unit Aim	Learners will understand project management concepts and the processes and tools used by organisations to manage IT projects. They will learn about project management methodologies and use project management software to plan an IT project, track progress, and review the outcomes to determine project success.
Learning Outcomes	Assessment Criteria
The learner will:	The learner can:
1. Understand the principles of project management and the methodologies used by organisations to manage IT projects.	1.1 Explain the stages of the project lifecycle as they apply to a given IT project. 1.2 Describe key concepts, issues and risks when managing IT projects. 1.3 Compare the characteristics of different project management methodologies used by organisations.
2. Be able to use project management software to plan an IT project.	2.1 Produce a project specification for an IT project in line with requirements. 2.2 Use project management software to plan an IT project.
3. Be able to use project management software to monitor and review an IT project.	3.1 Use project management software to monitor a project plan and track progress against the plan. 3.2 Carry out a post-project review to determine project outcomes.

Maths for Computing (MC):

Unit Aim	Learners will develop maths skills for computing, including matrices, series and probability. Learners will also apply number systems, including binary and hexadecimal, and interpret data gathered for a defined purpose.
Learning Outcomes	Assessment Criteria
The learner will:	The learner can:
1. Be able to apply matrix methods.	1.1 Show how matrices can be used to represent ordered data 1.2 Perform add, subtract and scalar multiplication operations on a matrix. 1.3 Multiply two matrices. 1.4 Find the inverse and transpose of a matrix. 1.5 Apply matrix techniques to solve simultaneous linear equations.
2. Be able to apply sequences and series, probability and recursion	2.1 Apply sequence and series techniques to solve problems. 2.2 Apply probability and recursion techniques to solve problems.
3. Be able to apply number systems	3.1 Explain how number systems are used in computing. 3.2 Perform basic operations on number systems. 3.3 Perform conversion operations between number systems.
4. Be able to interpret data.	4.1 Gather data for a defined purpose. 4.2 Interpret trends and patterns in data.

Robot Technology (RT):

Unit Aim	Learners will develop an understanding of the principles and operations of robots. They will learn about robot control systems, the different types of sensors and their application in a robot. Learners will also develop the skills to design and develop a program to control a robot and will understand the role and importance of legislation associated with robot technology.
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Learning Outcomes	Assessment Criteria
The learner will:	The learner can:
1. Understand the operating, design and control principles of different types of robots.	1.1 Explain the operating, design and control principles of different types of robots. 1.2 Explain how different sensors and end effectors are used in robots. 1.3 Analyse the benefits and limitations of using robots for routine tasks.
2. Understand the legal and ethical issues in the development and use of robots.	2.1 Explain how legislation and roboethics influence the development and use of robots.
3. Be able to design and develop an operating program for a robot.	3.1 Design an operating program for a robot to enable it to carry out a specific function. 3.2 Develop an operating program for a robot to enable it to carry out a specific function.
4. Understand hazards and health, safety and maintenance requirements associated with robots.	4.1 Explain the health and safety requirements, and maintenance procedures for the safe operation of robots.

Assessments

Each module will have an assessment at the end of it. All assessments must be passed by the end of the course for you to achieve your diploma. You will have a session with your Facilitator to discuss the assessments in more detail.

The assessment schedule is not able to be changed, so please ensure you read through this fully. If you are not able to attend an assessment, please contact Student Care or your Facilitator as soon as possible so we can discuss this with you.

Don't panic if you receive a fail grade, you have resit opportunities throughout the course!



How Code Institute will support you

- 1 Facilitation
- 2 Community
- 3 Community Tutoring
- 4 Career Support
- 5 Student Care



Facilitation

You will meet with your facilitator during your stand up calls and they will be active in your Slack channel.

In your stand up calls, you will:

- Have discussions around your projects and project ideas
- Share study tips to help you progress
- Share weekly wins to keep you motivated

To get the most out of your facilitator's support, you should:

- Attend each stand up session. If you're not able to attend, please make sure your facilitator is aware and check the call summary posted after the call to see what you missed
- Be engaged in the sessions and the channel- ask questions and contribute to the discussion.
- Reach out to them one-to-one if you need support - they will always point you in the right direction if they're not able to help you themselves

Your facilitator will also be checking your progress throughout your course, so expect to hear from them if they haven't heard from you recently.

Your facilitator has a lot of software development experience so they are able to use this to help support your learning. Make the most of this opportunity and reach out to them if you need help!



Community & Community Tutoring



Slack - Your virtual campus

Slack is a virtual space where you can ask questions, post ideas and discoveries and encourage your classmates.

Students say that the supportive Code Institute Slack community is a very valuable part of their learning journey so we encourage you to get started from day one!

- You can join in the discussions or make calls to your classmates
- Introduce yourself in your class channel
- Say “hello” each day in your class channel and get to know your classmates

On the left side of the Slack app is a list of all channels. Most of the channels are named after a module in the course so you can ask specific questions here. There is channel just for your class - one of the great things about your course is that your entire class receives its own private channel. Use this channel for general discussion and sharing of ideas.

At Code Institute, you're part of a vibrant and diverse community on Slack, connecting learners across a range of courses. While course materials, assessments, and subject matter may vary, this variety enriches our Slack interactions. Keep in mind that some channels, content or discussions may not be directly related to your specific course, but they all contribute to the dynamic, collaborative experience that makes the Code Institute community so unique.



Community Tutoring

Community Tutors are available in Slack to help you with any technical queries

To make use of this support, please post any technical questions in the relevant Slack channel. The Tutor will allow some time for your fellow classmates to respond to your query before providing input. This is to help with:

- Improving problem definition
- Improving problem solving competency
- Developing logic skills

The Tutors are online 9am-5:30pm Monday to Friday. If you have a questions outside of these hours, please still ask it! Your peers may be able to provide some answers in the meantime, but the Tutor will respond to any unanswered questions upon their return.



Career Support



You will benefit from well-presented, clear documents such as your CV and Cover Letter, and be visible in a professional online sense through your use of LinkedIn.

By working through these Masterclasses, you'll produce some great documents and benefit from our advice, insight, and practical informed tips on how to get started.

Once completed you'll have:

- Your new Tech CV
- Your Tech Cover Letter
- Your LinkedIn profile with a plan on how to use all these.

As this course aims to help students access a new career in Tech, Code Institute is responsible for reporting on our students' success post-course completion. Participation in this course means you are willing to share this information for up to 12 months post-competition.



Jane Gormley
Director of Employer Engagement

Student Care



Student Care

Student Care are the non technical support throughout your course.

They can help with:

- General questions
- Welfare and wellbeing support
- Signposting to other teams for more information

You can contact them by:

- Phone: +353 1 539 4937 9-5 Irish time Monday to Friday
- Email: studentcare@codeinstitute.net
- You can also send an email through the Student Support tab on the LMS.

There are no silly questions! If something is on your mind and you're not sure who to turn to, Student Care will do their best to help and point you in the right direction.



Student Care

Here to help with any general questions or issues with the programme, schedule or supports.

Contact Student Care

Safeguarding

- ✓ This is the process of protecting children and at-risk adults from harm, abuse, neglect or exploitation.
- ✓ **Our safeguarding policy is located in the [student experience handbook](#) in the LMS.** Please try to familiarise yourself with the policy for guidelines and procedures.
- ✓ If you have any safeguarding concerns or need to report an incident, please contact any staff at Code Institute. You can also fill out an [anonymous referral form](#) or speak to our designated safeguarding leads about the concern.
- ✓ Safeguarding is everyone's responsibility.
- ✓ Stay informed, be aware of potential risks, and report concerns promptly.

The Safeguarding Team



Mike Sheehan
michael.sheehan@codei
nstitute.net

Maria McLoughlin
maria.mcloughlin@codei
nstitute.net



Jeantelle van Niekerk
jeantelle.vanniekerk@code
institute.net



Where is our Safeguarding Policy?

Need support with your learning?

Select an option that best suits your request from the options below:



Student Handbook

View Code Institute's policies and procedures in this comprehensive handbook.

[View Student Handbook](#)



Student Care

Here to help with any general questions or issues with the programme, schedule or supports.

[Contact Student Care](#)



Safeguarding

Safeguarding Policy and Contact information.

[View Safeguarding Policy](#)



Troubleshooting

Learn how to solve coding issues yourself and discover other resources about the process of learning to code.

[Troubleshoot It](#)



Slack Community

A vibrant community of fellow students, as well as mentors and Code Institute staff.

[Let's Slack](#)

Questions about Safeguarding?

- Read the Safeguarding policy - located in your [student experience handbook](#)
- If you are concerned please report to any member of staff

It's that simple!

Safeguarding is everyone's responsibility. If you have any questions please feel free to contact studentcare@codeinstitute.net



Planning your time

We start the course with great enthusiasm and intentions, but planning is key!

Set yourself up for success by planning out your study hours for each week. This will help you stay on track and put you on the path to success.

Everyone has a different schedule so do what works for you! If you prefer to study in the morning, evening or the weekend make sure you plan your studies in an achievable way.

If you are not a morning person avoid planning your study at 6am as it will be more difficult to commit that time consistently, instead plan for an evening or weekend study period.



What Code Institute needs from you

Use the supports



Do your research



Don't lose touch



Share your success



Time commitment





Industry-Approved
Curriculum



Flexible
Learning Options



High Success &
Satisfaction Rating



studentcare@codeinstitute.net